

Jonathan Carroll

Interdisciplinary artist & creative technologist · Halifax, NS
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EDUCATION

- 2025–2027 Master of Fine Arts (Studio), **NSCAD University**, Halifax, NS
Thesis research-creation: *The Land Speaks*, a geolocated browser-based augmented reality narrative for health and history in industrial Cape Breton. Autoethnographic research into epigenetic and environmental health impacts of industrial history, developed with family co-creators and archival research (Beaton Institute).
- 2011–2016 Bachelor of Fine Arts (Integrated Media), **OCAD University**, Toronto, ON

TEACHING & ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

- Fall 2026 Teaching Assistant, *Ideas and Process*, NSCAD University
- In dev. Course in development, *Place-Based Digital Art Lab* (3 credits), NSCAD University. Studio course in which students build image-based, geolocated, and site-specific AR works across three projects (kinship and animal companions, ghosting and hauntology, land and place), research place through land, history and spirituality, and collaboratively design the presentation context for the class's work. Includes outdoor studio sessions and a final critique held on site.
- Summer 2026 Research Assistant, *Art Factory: Offshoots Art Project* (Textiles/Fashion), NSCAD University. Lead artist Melinda Spooner, in partnership with CERI Eelgrass Project and Zuppa Theatre. Creating audio documentation and a sound score from underwater and shoreline recordings in the Prospect area, archiving project activity, and developing an interactive textile component.
Research Assistant / Workshop Facilitator, Community Mobile Media Lab, NSCAD University (Research Nova Scotia). Designed and led an immersive media workshop for NSCAD Art Camp: participants sculpted characters from felt and clay, photogrammetrically scanned them, and met them in augmented reality through *Living Characters*, a browser-based AR world-building tool.
- 2025–2026 Digital Exhibitions Consultant & Co-developer, [Landscapes of Digital Art](#), MacKenzie Art Gallery, Regina, SK. Contributed to the design and development of a two-year digital education project funded by the Canada Council for the Arts Digital Strategy Fund, including artist-led conversations, online workshops, and a web-based teacher resource for digital art literacy.
- Spring 2026 Research Assistant, [Media Art Week 2026](#), NSCAD University (David Clark). Developed the Media Art Week website and coordinated publication for the seminar series "Technologies of Experience," including the essay *Archive Panopticon*.
Studio Assistant, David Clark: developed and installed an interactive media installation for the Third Shift contemporary art festival, Saint John, NB.
- Winter 2026 Teaching Assistant, *Expanded Media Projects*, NSCAD University
- Fall 2025 Teaching Assistant, *Physical Computing*, NSCAD University
- 2022 Sessional Instructor, *Video Game Essays* (MAP 200AM), University of Regina. Remote studio-seminar (9 hours/week, 15–20 students) pairing game theory (Bogost, Wark, Custodio) with experimental game production in GB Studio and free pixel-art tools. Three exercises (perception and remix, narration through text, representation through a gallery) led to a final project; syllabus revised after delivery for clearer prompts, submission protocols, and project approval.
- 2021 Sessional Instructor, *Mixed Reality Performance Art* (ART 290AL), University of Regina. Remote studio course (7.5 hours/week, 15–20 students) on live-streamed performance with custom AR filters (OBS, Lens Studio, Snap Camera, VRChat), paired with readings in digital performance and media theory (Dixon, Krauss, Goffman, Noble). Three exercises built toward a final project; equipment-dependent VR work was demonstration-only so access did not affect grading.
Digital Artist in Residence / Facilitator, *Video Games by Artists*, MacKenzie Art Gallery, Regina, SK

2020–2022	Digital Exhibitions Consultant & Curatorial Developer, MacKenzie Art Gallery, Regina, SK. Developed <i>DETAIL</i> (Digital Exhibition Toolkit and Art Installation Launcher); co-curated <i>Ender Gallery</i> , a Minecraft artist residency with four commissioned artists, public programming, educational materials, and a public resource pack. Co-hosted online workshops and livestreams as Digital Programs Coordinator.
2016–2019	Faculty, <i>Game Design & 3D Animation</i> (video, animation, game design), OCAD University Continuing Studies, Toronto, ON. Evening and weekend courses for adult learners with diverse backgrounds and experience levels.
2016–2018	Workshop Facilitator, Trinity Square Video, Toronto, ON. Drop-in and multi-week workshops in virtual reality, animation, and video editing.
2015–2016	Teaching Assistant, Foundation Media & Studio, OCAD University, Toronto, ON. Developed workshop materials, assisted instructors in media labs, and gave individual feedback on student projects.

SELECTED GROUP EXHIBITIONS

2025	<i>Party in the Front</i> (with Mailey Horner), textile installation and performance, Manchester, UK
2024	<i>Milan Machinima Festival</i> , Milan, Italy Critics Choice Award for “Assassin’s Creed Art History”
2023	<i>Open Systems 1: Open Worlds</i> , Singapore Art Museum, Singapore <i>GAN of Living Skies</i> , Art Gallery of Regina, Regina, SK <i>Particle & Wave Festival</i> , Emmedia Gallery, Calgary, AB
2022	<i>Video Games? Art and Technology</i> , Art Gallery of Grande Prairie, Grande Prairie, AB
2021	<i>Reality Crossing & Geofenced</i> , Interaccess Artist-run Centre, Toronto, ON <i>Ender Gallery: A Minecraft Artist Residency</i> , MacKenzie Art Gallery, Regina, SK A MAZE. Berlin, Germany
2020	<i>Regina Nuit Blanche</i> , Regina, SK
2019	<i>A.MAZE Video Game Art Festival</i> , Berlin, Germany <i>Nocturne Halifax</i> , Halifax, NS
2018	<i>Venice Architecture Biennale</i> , Venice, Italy <i>Resourced</i> (with Ben McCarthy), Mayworks Festival, Trinity Square Video, Toronto, ON

MAJOR PROJECTS

2026	<i>Living Characters</i> , browser-based AR world-building tool for NSCAD Art Camp: characters placed on a shared map, experienced in WebXR or camera-based AR with Three.js, dialogue trees, and Tweep export.
2025–26	<i>The Land Speaks</i> , geolocated browser-based AR narrative about industrial pollution and autoimmune illness in Sydney, Nova Scotia, using narrative agents such as a toxic dust particle and a household curtain.
2025–26	<i>Spatial Narrative</i> , location-aware interactive fiction system (SugarCube 2, GPS, compass, dwell-triggered passages) with a reader and a PWA authoring tool.
2025–26	<i>The Wrong John Carroll</i> , cemetery archive and pallet altar project; <i>Sourdough Synth</i> , sourdough as bioelectric signal for solar-powered sound.
2019–present	<i>VRIM (Virtual Reality Interactive Music)</i> , custom VR headset software and sound art composition tool for participatory electronic music performance in unconventional spaces such as forests, churches, galleries, and homes. Sounds made by the audience and the environs are sampled and processed into generative musical sequences, so each performance is unique to its space. Performed at the Art Gallery of Regina (2022) and developed at the Alchemy residency, Gibraltar Point Arts Centre (2025).
2021–2024	<i>DETAIL: Digital Exhibition Toolkit</i> , developer and curator of a software toolkit for digital art exhibitions using Unity3D. MacKenzie Art Gallery; Canada Council for the Arts Digital Strategy Fund.
2023	<i>GAN of Living Skies</i> , creator of a solar-powered AI landscape painting machine. Art Gallery of Regina; Saskatchewan Arts Council.
2022	<i>Assassin’s Creed Art History</i> , interactive video game exploring art history through archival research, part of a series of interactive “essays” that use assets from the Assassin’s Creed series as a lens on the representation of history in interactive media (captured in Unity as the animation <i>Gameworkers Guildworkers</i>). Art Gallery of Grande Prairie; Milan Machinima Festival (Critics Choice Award, 2024).

2022	<i>Hypercity</i> , GPS-based augmented reality exhibition across Toronto featuring six artists. Long Winter Festival; Canada Council Digital Now.
2021	<i>Ender Gallery: A Minecraft Artist Residency</i> , custom Minecraft mod and technical development for a four-part residency and exhibition series. MacKenzie Art Gallery; A MAZE. Berlin.
2021	<i>Escape from Intern Purgatory</i> , augmented reality app accompanying a graphic novel. Eyelevel Gallery; Nova Scotia Arts Council; Canada Council Digital Now.
2018–24	SpekWork Studio (with Cat Bluemke), games about labour. Gigco: Escape the Gig Economy , game and Unity-captured animation about the gig economy and automation; TAP Cop , browser-based idle game about defunding the police and refunding social programs; CO-OP Copter Scabs , game-jam helicopter simulator made during a refinery lockout in Regina, in which the player either flies scabs over the picket line or joins it.
2018	Resourced , virtual reality documentary with sound artist Ben McCarthy presenting the self-narrated stories of frontline workers (a street nurse, a harm reduction nurse, and social workers) affected by austerity, vicarious trauma, and mounting precarity, with interview content expressed through interactive metaphors, 3D-scanned animated figures, and spatial sound design. Mayworks Festival , Trinity Square Video, Toronto.
n.d.	Proof of Stake , an attempt to make art on the blockchain: 3D scans of property markers made in the woods of rural Nova Scotia, minted as interactive objects on the Tezos blockchain via hicetnunc.xyz.

ARTIST TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

2026	Speaker, Hub Talks , Design Department, NSCAD University (October 14) Conference presentation, Atlantic Art Teachers' Conference (October 22) Presentation, Poetry and Game Conference, Manchester Metropolitan University, UK Presentation, "Cheap and Dirty Websites," Media Arts Week, NSCAD University Presentation, "Systems and Simulations," Media Arts Week, NSCAD University
2024	Artist Talk, Milan Machinima Festival, Milan, Italy
2022	Artist Talk, Alberta University of the Arts, Calgary, AB
2021	Artist Talk, University of Regina, Regina, SK; MUTEK Montreal Presentation, Canadian Association of Art Gallery Educators Symposium Presentation, "Museums after COVID-19: Innovations for the Next New Normal," Alberta Museums Association Presentation, <i>Ender Gallery: A Minecraft Artist Residency</i> , A MAZE. Berlin, Germany
2019	Artist Talk, MacKenzie Art Gallery, Regina, SK Panel, Rendezvous with Madness Festival, Workman Arts, Toronto Panel, "Virtual Reality as Empathy Machine," Toronto Metropolitan University Artist Talks, George Brown College and Toronto Metropolitan University, Toronto, ON
2018	Artist Talk, Media Design Practices, ArtCenter, Pasadena, CA Presentation, Train Jam, Game Developers Conference, San Francisco, CA

PUBLICATIONS & MEDIA

2026	"Archive Panopticon" , essay and interactive archive, published as part of the seminar series "Technologies of Experience" organized for Media Art Week 2026.
2023	"From Algorithms to Aesthetics: Unlocking the Mind of CritBot.AI" , co-author, <i>C Magazine</i>
2022	"Minecraft to Metaverse: A Year of Experimental Art and Curation Inside Proprietary Platforms" , co-author with Sarah Friend and Cat Bluemke, <i>BlackFlash Magazine</i>
2020	"Gone in a Flash" , co-organizer and co-author, MacKenzie Art Gallery & Neutral Ground Artist-Run Centre
2019	CBC Arts, featured interview (GIGCO: Escape the Gig Economy)
2017	The Globe and Mail, Toronto Star, CBC Arts, featured coverage

AWARDS & FUNDING

2025	Nova Scotia Graduate Scholarship, NSCAD University
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2024	Critics Choice Award, Milan Machinima Festival Canada Council for the Arts – Arts Abroad
2023	Arts Nova Scotia – Grants to Individuals (Media Arts) Canada Council for the Arts – Arts Across Canada
2022	Canada Council for the Arts – Explore and Create
2021	Canada Council for the Arts – Digital Now Saskatchewan Arts Board – Media Arts
2020	Saskatchewan Arts Board
2019	Arts Nova Scotia; Canada Council for the Arts – Arts Abroad Travel
2018	Rhizome – Microgrants in Virtual Reality
2017	Toronto Arts Council – Open Door Grant
2014	Canada Council for the Arts – New Media & Audio Artists Toronto Arts Council – Media Arts

RESIDENCIES

2025	<i>Alchemy</i> , Gibraltar Point Arts Centre, Toronto, ON
2017	<i>The Lean Artist</i> , Praxis, Oslo, Norway